the da te of adoption of the present resolution and those set out in

Annex 2 should enter into force on 1 January 2009;

3. STRONGLY URGES Contracting Governments to the Convention to meet their

obligations under SOLAS regulation XI-1/5 and resolution A.959(23) and, in particular, when a

MEPC 79/10. All references used in this resolution are set out in the annex to document MEPC 79/10.

Number of ships

Number of sailings

RESOLUTION MEPC.380(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)

DESIGNATION OF THE NORTH-WESTERN MEDITERRANEAN SEA AS A PARTICULARLY SENSITIVE SEA AREAMEPC 80/17/Add.1

Annex 20, page 13

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Operational factors

1.4 In the North-Western Mediterranean, shipping traffic is mainly structured towards or

from the ports of Valencia, Tarragona, Barcelona, Marseille, Genoa, La Spezia and Livorno for

goods traffic, to which are added the ports of Toulon, Sète, Nice, Savona and all ports in the

islands of Corsica, Sardinia, the Tuscan archipelago, Sicily and the Balearic Islands for

passenger transport. This geographical situation of proximity to the islands, combined with

commercial port infrastructures, promotes maritime f erry traffic. Moreover, the cruise activity

has largely developed in the Mediterranean, benefiting from favourable weather conditions and

dedicated infrastructures: the region represents the second world market for this sector, after

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has largely developed in the Mediterranean, benefiting from favourable weather conditions and

dedicated infrastructures: the region represents the second world market for this sector, after

the Caribbean (Di -Méglio et al., 2010). Finally, more than 700 marinas are listed in the

Mediterranean basin.

Vessel types

1.5 A study conducted by the Quiet Oceans consultancy on behalf of WWF (Gallou and

Folegot, 2020) analysed shipping traffic in the North -Western Mediterranean, using AIS data

from 2019. In terms of distance travelled in this area, passenger ships and cargo ships travel

by far the greatest distance, followed by motorized pleasure craft and fishing vessels.

Traffic characteristics

1.6 Freight traffic is higher in winter, in the northern part of the study area, along the

coasts of the Gulf of Lion, towards Barcelona and with Corsica and Sardinia. Passenger traffic

is highly structured around links between the main ports of France, Spain and Italy on the

one

hand, and Corsica, the Balearic Islands, Sardinia and the Tuscan archipelago on the other.

Traffic intensity increases significantly during the summer months for passenger transport

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hand, and Corsica, the Balearic Islands, Sardinia and the Tuscan archipelago on the other.

Traffic intensity increases significantly during the summer months for passenger transport

between the Mediterranean islands and the mainlan d, as well as with additional connections

to North Africa and Barcelona and with cruise activity (see figures 5 and 6).

1.7 More than two thirds of the vessels using the study area (68% in winter and 71% in

summer) fly a European flag, representing more than 70% of the cumulative distances

travelled, whatever the season.

Figure 5: Representation of the maritime traffic during the winter period (2019, AIS source).

Figure 6: Representation of the maritime traffic during the summer period (2018, AIS source).

Harmful substances carried

1.8 The rules on the transport of harmful substances are derived from the International

Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, known as the MARPOL Convention.

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1.8 The rules on the transport of harmful substances are derived from the International

Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships, known as the MARPOL Convention.

These rules are contained in different international codes, depending on the nature and mode

of transport of these substances. The Mediterranean is an important transport route, but also

a major oil loading and unloading centre. It is also a major route for tankers.

1.9 In 2006, about 18% of the world's crude oil shipping, representing 4,224 voyages

and 421 million tonnes, took place in the Mediterranean (MIU, 2008). Of the 10 main ports